GOSPEL READING: Matthew 21: 33-43

Jesus said to the chief priests and the elders of the people, 'Listen to another parable. There was a man, a landowner, who planted a vineyard; he fenced it round, dug a winepress in it and built a tower; then he leased it to tenants and went abroad.
When vintage time drew near he sent his servants to the tenants to collect his produce. But the tenants seized his servants, thrashed one, killed another and stoned a third. Next he sent some more servants, this time a larger number, and they dealt with them in the same way.
Finally, he sent his son to them. "*They will respect my son*" he said. But when the tenants saw the son, they said to each other, "*This is the heir. Come on, let us kill him and take over his inheritance*."
So they seized him and threw him out of the vineyard and killed him. Now when the owner of the vineyard comes, what will he do to those tenants?' They answered, 'He will bring those wretches to a wretched end and lease the vineyard to other tenants who will deliver the produce to him when the season arrives.'
Jesus said to them, 'Have you never read in the scriptures: It was the stone rejected by the builders that became the keystone. This was the Lord's doing and it is wonderful to see?
I tell you, then, that the kingdom of God will be taken from you and given to a people who will produce its fruit.'

The Gospel of the Lord. **Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.**

✝ ✝ ✝ ✝ ✝ ✝ ✝

Continued from front page/……..

He famously preached to birds, tamed the wolves, and addressed the sun, moon, and elements as "Brother" and "Sister." In the final years of his life, Francis's deep immersion in Christ's passion culminated in a remarkable mystical experience. In 1224, he received the stigmata—the physical wounds of the crucified Christ—becoming the first recorded individual in Christian history to bear these marks. Yet, as his health deteriorated his inner joy never wavered.

His name was deliberately chosen by Pope Francis, who has utilized the saint's legacy to guide the global Church toward a renewed focus on marginalised populations and environmental protection, most notably through the encyclical, Laudato si'. Ultimately, the 800th anniversary of Saint Francis of Assisi is not merely a historical retrospective, but a living invitation. His life demonstrates that true wealth is discovered in self-emptying love, authentic peace is forged through humble dialogue, and human survival is deeply intertwined with a reverent care for creation. Eight centuries later, the gentle friar of Assisi still invites the world to rebuild our lives and move towards God.



The year 2026 marks a profound milestone in Christian history and global spirituality: the 800th anniversary of the death of St Francis. On the evening of October 3, 1226, this great saint passed away at the age of forty-four, stripped of his earthly possessions and lying humbly on the bare earth at the Porziuncola chapel. Eight centuries later, the legacy of the beloved "Little Poor Man"—remains an enduring, powerful beacon of peace, radical love, and environmental stewardship. The global commemoration, anchored by a Vatican proclaimed Franciscan Jubilee Year, offers a timeless opportunity for modern believers to reflect on a life that continues to challenge us today.

Born into luxury as the son of a wealthy cloth merchant in Assisi. The decisive turning point in his life arrived at the crumbling chapel of San Damiano, where Francis heard a crucifix speak to him: "Go and repair my house, which is falling into ruin." Initially taking the command literally, Francis sold his father's cloth to fund repairs, and declared that from that day forward he would recognise only "Our Father who art in heaven." This radical renunciation marked the birth of a spiritual revolution.

Francis embraced a life of absolute poverty, choosing to become an itinerant preacher and beggar. His magnetic joy and uncompromising adherence to the Gospel quickly attracted companions, which allowed him to start the Order of Friars Minor in 1209. Francis and his brothers lived directly among the public, ministering to outcasts, lepers, and the destitute. Their simple lifestyle, provided a stunning, prophetic alternative to the institutional wealth of the medieval Church at that time.

His vision expanded further through the co-founding of the Poor Clare's with Saint Clare of Assisi, and the establishment of the Secular Franciscan Order, allowing laypeople to live out Franciscan charisms within their secular callings. Francis sought fraternity rather than conquest, exemplifying the peace prayer traditionally attributed to his heritage.

Equally revolutionary was his mystical intimacy with creation, beautifully captured in his masterpiece, the *"Canticle of the Sun."* Long before the advent of modern ecology, Francis recognised all living things as interconnected expressions of divine love.

Continues on back page/..

Monday, 5th October - St Faustina Kowalska

8.00am: Nell Mooney. Get well.
10.00am: Liam & Annie Glennon & DFM

Tuesday, 6th October

8.00am: Kevin & Eddie O'Reilly & DFM
10.00am: Joe & Tess Cullen & DFM

Wednesday, 7th October - Our Lady of the Rosary

8.00am: No Intention
10.00am: Special Birthday Intention

Thursday, 8th October

8.00am: Zoe Stokes (2nd A)
10.00am: Patrick & Sabina Doris, son P.J. & daughter Margaret (A)
7.30pm Curry: No Intention

Friday, 9th October - St John Henry Newman
Children's Day of Mission Prayer

8.00am: No Intention. **10.00am**: Ellen & Tom Egan & DFM

Saturday, 10th October

8.00am: Kitty McGlynn (B'day Rem)
10.00am: P.O. Johnson (A)

Sunday, 11th October - Twenty Eighth Sunday in Ordinary Time
'Prisoners' Sunday

7.30pm Vigil: Kathleen Linnane & Marie McGill
Joseph & Teresa Hackett & DFM
Jimmy & Philomena Orohoe (A)

8.00am: **Mass for People of the Parish (Missa Pro Populo)**

10.00am: Celira Gracias (B'day Intention)
Florrie Geelan (1st A)

11.30am: Matt (3rd), Sean, Patricia & John Farrelly (A)
May O'Halloran (1st A)

1.00pm: Vera Gallagher (A)
William Beahan (A)
Stefen Kroscen (A)

6.00pm: Joan Ryan (8th A)

OFFERTORY COLLECTION: Thank you most sincerely for your generous contribution to our collection last week which amounted to €4,480.00.

BAPTISM: With great joy we welcomed Esmé Philomena Doyle and Amélia Patrice Máire Seoighe into the Christian community last weekend.

✝ **RECENTLY DECEASED** We remember in our prayers Mary Okwechime. Her funeral Mass will be celebrated in the Cathedral on Saturday morning at 11am. May her soul, and the souls of all the faithful departed, rest in peace.

CHILDREN'S DAY OF MISSION PRAYER - Friday 9th October - Children are encouraged to pray together, for each other, and for children living in poverty and fear.

MISSION APPEAL in aid of the Franciscan Missionaries will take place at all masses **Saturday/Sunday 10th/11th October.** Br. Brian Johnson will speak at all masses.

BLESSING OF MOTOR VEHICLES - Blessing of keys for motorbikes, cars, vans, trucks, and other motor vehicles will take place after all masses **Saturday & Sunday 10th & 11th October**, to mark the culmination of National Road Safety Week 2026.

OCIA - Order of Christian Initiation for Adults - Do you want to be baptised? Do you want to enter full communion with the Church? The OCIA is a programme of formation in the faith. Classes for over-18 year olds who would like to be baptised, OR are baptised and would like to make their First Holy Communion or Confirmation, will commence early in November. Please contact the Parish Office.

ANNUAL BEREAVEMENT MASS 2026 will take place on **Saturday 7th November** at the 7.30pm mass. The 2027 Diary will be available from **Monday 5th October only** for those who would like to book a First Anniversary Mass. The Diary will be available from **Monday 2nd November** for booking of all other masses.

HOSPICE COFFEE MORNING: A big 'Thank You' to all who came to the coffee morning or sent donations to the coffee morning that took place in the crypt on Friday 25th September. The money raised, €273.30 has been handed over to Hospice Team.

MEDJUGORJE WEEKEND RETREAT led by Fr Jason Lewis (Medjugorje Chaplain) in St John's Day Care Centre, Knock Shrine, from Friday 23th October to Sunday 25th October. Booking is essential, for more info contact Nicola at 087 9622800.

TRLEI is a new employment support service for members of the Traveller and Roma community is now available in Longford. Free confidential, one to one support with jobs, CVs training, education, and enterprise. For an appointment, please contact Bronagh on 086 0750780



PARISH OF CASHEL NEWSLETTER
Merlyn Kenny 086 0603433 · 27th Sunday in Ordinary Time A 26



Sat	3rd	Oct	8.00pm:	1. Kathleen Fallon, (month's mind).
				2. Paddy Greene, Elfeet & dfm.
Sun	4th	Oct	10.30am:	Mary Ann Hand, (month's mind).
Mon	5th	Oct	8.00pm:	Special Intention.
Tues	6th	Oct	8.00pm:	Special Intention.
Thurs	8th	Oct	8.00pm:	Special Intention.
Fri	9th	Oct	8.00pm:	Private Intention.
Sat	10th	Oct	8.00pm:	Paddy & Cissie Farrell, Carrowbeg.

Eucharistic Adoration - continues Wednesday from 3pm-9pm & Friday 8.30pm-9pm.

Rosary: Sat 3rd Oct: Margaret Brennan. Sat 10th Oct: Liz Hanley.
Eucharistic Ministers' Roster: Sat 10th Oct: Teresa Costello & Mary Casey.
Readers' Roster: Sat 10th Oct: Anne Kenny.

Please pray for the repose of the soul of Bernadette Farrell (nee McDermott), Stonepark, Longford, (mother of Michelle Donnelly (Newtowncashel. Requiem Mass on Monday 5th October in St. Mel's Cathedral at 11.00am.

ICA Newtowncashel Guild meet on Tuesday 6th October in the Hill at 8pm.
Well done to all who took part in the September Federation competitions. The Drama committee are looking for actors for "The Outing" which will be held in An Grianan on 14th March 2027. Lots of events to look forward to in October including the Cookery Cup on 20th October. The Longford weekend in An Grianan is on the 14th-16th May 2027 and includes courses on embroidery, pottery, jewellery making and relaxation. Come along on Tuesday night to find out more.

The Annual Pioneer Dinner Dance takes place in The Rustic Inn, Abbeyshrule on Friday 16th of October. Contact Oliver on 086 8598273 for tickets.

Funeral Ministry introduction commences on Wednesday 30th September and will continue on the consecutive Wednesdays 7th and 14th October. Tea/coffee at 7pm and workshop starting at 7.30pm. Please invite at least 2 parishioners who are involved in liturgy preparation or the Pastoral Council, to attend for each of the three nights. Please book via Fr Turlough Baxter 087 997 2259/turlough.baxter@gmail.com

Lotto draw held on Monday 28th Sept 2026. No's drawn: 01-03-15-29. No jackpot winner. Draw winners: €30 €5 envelopes to Kathleen Casey, €30 to Michael Duffy, €20 each to Jamie & Megan Campbell and Frank Killilea. Next weeks draw will be held in The Local on Monday 5th October and the Jackpot is €4,400. Lotto team on next week's draw is Ronan Muldoon, Declan Murtagh and Jack Bannon. Thanks for your support.

The meaning of the parable: 1) Like the Jews, the second- and third-generation Christians also understood God as the landlord. The servants sent by the landowner represented the prophets of the Old Testament. They were to see to it that God's Chosen People produced fruits of justice, love, and righteousness. But the people refused to listen to the prophets and produced the bitter grapes of injustice, immorality, and idolatry. They persecuted and killed the prophets. As a final attempt, the landowner sent his son, (Jesus), to collect the rent (fruits of righteousness), from the wicked tenants (the Jews). But they crucified him and continued to lead a lives of disloyalty and disobedience. Hence, God's vineyard was to be taken away from His chosen people and given to a people (Gentile Christians), who were expected to produce fruits of righteousness. "The basic theological thrust of the parable of the vineyard is to place the suffering and death of Jesus in line with the mistreatment of God's messengers throughout the centuries.
2) The Lord's Vineyard at present is the Church, and we Christians are the tenants from whom God expects fruits of righteousness. The parable warns us that if we refuse to reform our lives, and to become spiritual fruit-producers we, too, could be replaced, just as the old Israel was replaced by us. As good tenants of God's Vineyard, we need to pay serious attention to relating to others as loving fellow-servants to our common Master. In the parable, the rent the tenants refuse to pay stands for the relationship with God and with all the people of Israel which the religious leaders refuse to cultivate. This means that before anything else, God checks on how well we are fulfilling our responsibilities to each other as children of God. The parable teaches that instead of glorying in isolated splendor, rejoicing in our privileges and Christian heritage, we are called to deeds of love, compassion, patience, generous assistance, forgiveness and mercy, for these are the witness-bearing personal and corporate actions and attitudes that invite and welcome others into God's kingdom.
Life messages: 1) Are we good fruit-producers in the vineyard of the Church? Jesus has given the Church everything necessary to make Christians fruit-bearing. a) The Bible to know the will of God. b) The Sacrament of Holy Orders to consecrate bishops, priests, and deacons to lead the people in God's ways. c) The Sacrament of Reconciliation for the remission of sins. d) The Holy Eucharist as our spiritual food. e) The Sacrament of Confirmation for a dynamic life of Faith. f) The Sacrament of Matrimony for the sharing of love in families, the fundamental unit of the Church. g) The Sacrament of (Last) Anointing to restore and strengthen spiritual life and bring mental emotional and physical healing as well, if that is what God wills. h) Role models in thousands of saints. We are expected make use of these gifts to produce fruits for God.

2) Are we fruit-producers in the vineyard of the family? By the mutual sharing of blessings, by sacrificing time and talents for the members of the family, by humbly and lovingly serving others in the family, by recognizing and encouraging each other and by honoring and gracefully obeying our parents, we become producers of "good fruit" for the Vine, Christ, in our families, and so give Glory to God.

3) Are we ready to face these hard questions? What kind of grapes do we as a parish community produce? Are they sweet or sour? What is our attitude toward everything God has given to us? Are we grateful stewards for everything God has given to us, or are we like the ungrateful tenants who acted as if they owned everything God had given them? Do we practice justice every day of our lives? Do we recognize the righteousness of God that keeps us from self-righteousness? Do we remember to show mercy? Is our parish a real sign of Jesus' presence and love?